China and with parties in Indonesia and other countries of the Middle East and South-East Asia. Resolutions of the Indian National Congress repeatedly spoke out against imperialism.

As World War II approached, Congress resolutions opposed fascism and Nazism: criticizing Japan's aggression against Manchuria, Italy's taking over of Abyssinia and Germany's dismemberment of Czechoslovakia. Not only did the Congress pass resolutions but it also raised funds and sent aid for the Abyssinian and Spanish loyalist causes. As foreign secretary of the Congress party, Nehru visited Spain, Czechoslovakia, Russia and even Chungking in China.[76]

At the 1938 Haripura session of the Congress, a resolution was passed that the '… people of India desire to live in peace and friendship with their neighbours and with all other countries and for this purpose wish to remove all causes of conflict between them. Striving for their own freedom and independence as a nation, they wish to respect the freedom of others and to build up their strength on the basis of international cooperation and goodwill.' The resolution further stated:

> India can be no party to such an imperialist war and will not permit her manpower and resources to be exploited in the interests of British imperialism. Nor can India join any war without the express consent of her people. The Congress therefore entirely disapproves of war preparations being made in India and large-scale manoeuvres and air raid precautions by which it has been sought to spread an atmosphere of approaching war in India. In the event of an attempt being made to involve India in a war this will be resisted. [77]

A few months later, in September 1939, the Congress Working Committee issued a statement, declaring: 'If the war is to defend the status quo, imperialist possessions, colonies, vested interests and privilege then India can have nothing to do with it. If, however, the issue is democracy and a world order based on democracy then India is intensely interested in it.' [78]